

Practical AI for Actuaries

Delegate setup guide - Windows

Please complete this setup before the next practical session. These detailed instructions are for Windows. If you use macOS, Linux or WSL, use the prompt in Section 12.

IMPORTANT - copy terminal commands from setup_instructions.txt: Use this PDF for explanations and links. Do not copy terminal commands from the PDF because a PDF reader may insert unwanted line breaks. Open the attached **setup_instructions.txt** file and copy each terminal command from there, one command at a time. In the VS Code terminal, paste with **Ctrl+V**, right-click and choose **Paste**, or use **Shift+Insert**. Do not use Ctrl+C to paste: in a terminal, Ctrl+C normally stops the current command.

1. Accounts and subscriptions

Claude Pro and Claude Code

Claude Pro costs approximately US\$20 per month, before any applicable taxes, and includes access to Claude Code. You can cancel after the course if you decide not to continue.

- [Open Claude to sign in or create an account](#)

ChatGPT

A free ChatGPT account is sufficient for these sessions. A paid ChatGPT Plus subscription is not required.

- [Open ChatGPT](#)
- [Download the ChatGPT desktop app](#)

OpenAI API credit

ChatGPT subscriptions and OpenAI API credit are separate. Add at least US\$5 of prepaid credit in the OpenAI Platform billing area so that exercises using the API can run. Prepaid credit expires after one year. You may leave automatic recharge switched off.

- [OpenAI Platform billing](#)

2. Install these two items from the web

Install these first, using their official websites.

Visual Studio Code

First check which type of Windows PC you have:

1. Open **Start > Settings > System > About**.
2. Under **Device specifications**, find **System type**.
3. If it says **x64-based processor**, choose the **Windows x64 User Installer**. This is the usual choice for PCs with Intel or AMD processors.
4. Only if it says **ARM-based processor**, choose the **Windows Arm64 User Installer**.

Go to [the official VS Code download page](#). In the Windows section, choose **User Installer** in the correct x64 or Arm64 column. Do not choose the System Installer, ZIP or command-line download.

If VS Code is already installed, open it and apply any available update.

Git for Windows and Git Bash

Open the [Git for Windows download page](#).

- If **System type** says **x64-based processor**, select the first **Click here to download** link. It downloads the x64 installer used by most Intel and AMD Windows PCs.
- If **System type** says **ARM-based processor**, do not use the first x64 link. Scroll to **Other Git for Windows downloads > Standalone Installer** and choose **Git for Windows/ARM64 Setup**.
- Choose a **Setup** or **Standalone Installer**, not a Portable version.

Accepting the normal installation choices is suitable for this course. Git for Windows includes Git Bash, which we will use as the terminal inside VS Code.

3. Make Git Bash the default terminal in VS Code

1. Open VS Code.
2. Select **Terminal > New Terminal**.
3. Select the small arrow beside the plus sign in the Terminal panel.
4. Choose **Select Default Profile**.
5. Select **Git Bash**.
6. Close the current terminal and open a new one.

The terminal prompt should now indicate that you are using Bash.

4. Check that Windows Package Manager is available

In the Git Bash terminal inside VS Code, enter:

```
winget.exe --version
```

If a version number appears, continue to the next section.

If Windows says that `winget` cannot be found, install or update **App Installer** from the Microsoft Store, restart VS Code, then try the command again.

[Read Microsoft's Windows Package Manager guidance](#).

5. Install the system tools from Git Bash

Open **setup_instructions.txt** and use it to copy the commands in this section. Do not copy terminal commands from the PDF. Copy one complete line, paste it into the Git Bash terminal inside VS Code, press **Enter**, and wait for it to finish before copying the next line. If Windows asks you to accept an agreement, type **Y** and press **Enter**.

Node.js - current long-term-support version

```
winget.exe install -e --id OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
```

Python 3.12

```
winget.exe install -e --id Python.Python.3.12 --scope user
```

This installation includes `pip` and adds Python to your user PATH automatically.

uv - fast Python package and environment manager

```
winget.exe install -e --id astral-sh.uv
```

[Read the official uv installation documentation.](#)

Claude Code

```
winget.exe install -e --id Anthropic.ClaudeCode
```

[Read the official Claude Code installation guidance.](#)

6. Restart VS Code, then verify the installations

Close every VS Code window completely and reopen VS Code. This allows it to pick up the updated Windows PATH.

Open a new Git Bash terminal and run each command:

```
node --version
npm --version
python --version
py -3.12 --version
python -m pip --version
uv --version
claude --version
```

Each command should display a version number. Python should report version 3.12.

7. Install Codex CLI from Git Bash

After Node.js and npm have been verified, run:

```
npm install -g @openai/codex@latest
```

Then check it:

```
codex --version
```

[Read the official Codex CLI guide.](#)

8. Install the VS Code extensions

Install the extensions through the Extensions search screen, not through the terminal:

1. Press **Ctrl+Shift+X** to open the Extensions view. Alternatively, select the **Extensions** icon on the left of VS Code.
 2. Use the search box at the top of the Extensions view.
 3. Search for each extension below, one at a time.
 4. Check that the publisher matches the publisher shown below.
 5. Select **Install**.
- [OpenAI Codex](#) - publisher: OpenAI
 - [Claude Code for VS Code](#) - publisher: Anthropic
 - [Python](#) - publisher: Microsoft
 - [Jupyter](#) - publisher: Microsoft

9. ChatGPT settings

In ChatGPT on the web:

1. Open **Settings**.

2. Open **Personalization**.
3. Open **Custom Instructions** and paste in the custom instructions attached to the delegate email.
4. Make sure customization is enabled.
5. Switch **Memory** on.
6. In the **Advanced** area, switch on all available memory and personalization options.
7. Open **Settings > Data Controls**.
8. Switch **Improve the model for everyone** off.

These choices allow useful personalization while preventing new conversations from being used to improve the general model.

Optional further reading

The following links are optional. You do not need to read them to complete the setup:

- [Optional: ChatGPT Custom Instructions guidance](#)
- [Optional: ChatGPT Memory guidance](#)
- [Optional: ChatGPT Data Controls guidance](#)

10. Claude web settings

In the Claude web app:

1. Open **Settings**.
2. Under **Profile**, find **Instructions for Claude**.
3. Paste in the same custom instructions attached to the delegate email.
4. Open the **Privacy** tab.
5. Under **Preferences**, switch **Help improve our AI models** off.

Optional further reading

The following links are optional. You do not need to read them to complete the setup:

- [Optional: Claude personalization guidance](#)
- [Optional: Claude model-improvement privacy guidance](#)

11. If a command is not found

First close every VS Code window, reopen VS Code, and try the verification command again. A newly installed command often becomes available after this restart.

Python

The usual user-install folders are:

```
%LocalAppData%\Programs\Python\Python312\  
%LocalAppData%\Programs\Python\Python312\Scripts\
```

To locate the installed Python executable, run:

```
py -3.12 -c "import sys; print(sys.executable)"
```

If Python still cannot be found, open the Windows Start menu, search for **environment variables**, select **Edit environment variables for your account**, edit the **Path** entry, and add the two folders above. Then restart VS

Code.

npm-installed commands

The usual folder for npm global commands is:

```
%AppData%\npm
```

If codex cannot be found after restarting VS Code, add that folder to your user Path and restart VS Code again.

Claude Code cannot find Git Bash

Git Bash is normally located at:

```
C:\Program Files\Git\bin\bash.exe
```

If Claude Code asks for the Git Bash location, create or edit this file:

```
~/.claude/settings.json
```

Use:

```
{
  "env": {
    "CLAUDE_CODE_GIT_BASH_PATH": "C:\\Program Files\\Git\\bin\\bash.exe"
  }
}
```

12. macOS, Linux or WSL

Copy the following prompt into your AI assistant:

```
I am following Windows setup instructions for a Practical AI webinar, but my operating system is [state macOS, Linux distribution, or WSL distribution and version]. Rewrite the instructions for my operating system. Preserve the requested software and major versions, including Visual Studio Code, Git, Node.js LTS, Python 3.12, pip, uv, Codex CLI, Claude Code and the listed VS Code extensions. Use the native terminal and the safest appropriate package manager for my operating system. Do not give me PowerShell or Windows-only commands. Explain any PATH changes explicitly, tell me when to restart the terminal or VS Code, and finish with commands that verify every installation. Assume I am a beginner and provide numbered, copy-and-pasteable steps. Ask me about my operating-system version or processor type if that information is required before giving the commands.
```

13. Other files attached to the delegate email

The email also includes:

- **setup_instructions.txt** - copy all terminal commands from this file, not from the PDF;
- the custom instructions to use in ChatGPT and Claude;
- the NotebookLM workbook used to prepare the podcast material for the paper *Interpretable Boosted Linear Models*;
- the prompt used to generate that podcast; and
- the other prompts required for the practical exercises.

Keep these files together so they are easy to find during the webinars.